LISTEN · LEARN · SPEAK

Why Small Acts of Kindness Make You Happier

A hot chocolate experiment, why spending on others can make you happier, easy English for offering help and saying thank you – and two stories: a bread traffic jam and an old man in the rain.



Name: _____

Date: _____

My score: _____ / 100 ⭐

★ How to use this worksheet

1 · Before you listen 🧠
Do the warm-up and learn the key words. Questions with 🧠 can be answered before listening.

2 · While you listen 🎧
Answer the 🎧 questions. The ⏱ times show where to find each part of the video.

3 · After you listen 💬
Find the secret message, try one kind act a day – and tell us a kindness story!

0 Warm-up: My kindness check

fun · no points

Be honest! Tick everything that is true for you. 😊

- ☐ 🚪 I hold doors for people
- ☐ 📞 I call older relatives
- ☐ ⭐ I leave kind comments
- ☐ 🌷 I say nice things out loud
- ☐ 🛍️ I help people with bags
- ☐ 🙈 I find it hard to accept help

My kindness score: _____ / 6

Guess! On a cold day, people could keep a hot chocolate or give it to a stranger. How many gave it away?

(a) about 1 in 10 (b) about half (c) almost 9 in 10

🎧 **Check your guess at ⏱ 1:48**

Jack: "Would *you* give your hot chocolate away?" ☕



💬 Let's talk

Say your answers out loud – or write them in your notebook.

1. When was the last time a stranger was kind to you?

2. What small kind thing could you do today?

3. Is it easy for you to accept help? Why?

4. Who do you know with a "heart of gold"?

1 Key words

vocabulary · 10 points

Match each word or phrase (1–10) to its meaning (a–j). Write the letter in the box. 🧠 Then check at ⏱️ 12:46 and ⏱️ 13:51

- ☐ **1.** to underestimate
- ☐ **2.** to pay it forward
- ☐ **3.** generous
- ☐ **4.** considerate
- ☐ **5.** to go out of your way
- ☐ **6.** to make someone's day
- ☐ **7.** a compliment
- ☐ **8.** to bother someone
- ☐ **9.** a favour
- ☐ **10.** selfish

a) to make someone very happy, so their whole day feels better
b) something nice you say about someone
c) to think something is smaller or less important than it really is
d) to disturb someone who is busy
e) happy to give money, time or help to others
f) only thinking about yourself
g) to be kind to someone new, after someone was kind to you
h) something kind you do to help someone
i) thinking about how your actions affect other people
j) to make a special effort for someone, even if it's not easy



Pronunciation corner 🔊 **GEN**-er-ous · con-**SID**-er-ate · **COM**-pli-ment · un-der-**ES**-ti-mate · **FA**-vour. Careful: **compliment** (nice words) sounds just like **complement**, but it's spelled with an **i**! Say it: *"You made my day!"*

2 First listen: the big idea

listening · 2 points

Watch the whole episode once without stopping. Which sentence is the **main message**? 🎧

- (a) Kindness only matters when it's big and expensive, like a special present.
- (b) Small acts of kindness mean more to other people than we think – and they make us happier too.
- (c) It's better not to help strangers, because it always feels awkward.



Jack's tip: First listen = the **big picture**. Don't stop the video and don't worry about every word. Second listen = the **details**. That's when you answer the 🎧 questions.

🔮 **Predict before you listen!** (no points) Seven of these words are in the episode. One is **not**. Circle the one you think you **won't** hear – then check while you listen.

hot chocolate · croissants · glove · clock tower · envelope · ice rink · taxi · little dog

3 Know it or hear it? quiz + listening 10 points

Circle a, b or c. Questions 🧠 1–5: you can probably answer them **before** you listen. Questions 🎧 6–10: listen to find the answer.



🧠 YOU MIGHT ALREADY KNOW

1. Someone says "Thank you!" A natural reply is...

(a) "Nothing."
(b) "Don't mention it."
(c) "No, thanks."

🧠 Tricky – think about it!

2. "She's always very kind _____ me."

(a) with
(b) at
(c) to

🧠 Grammar you know

3. "Could you _____ me a favour?"

(a) make
(b) do
(c) give

🧠 Make or do?

4. "Thank you for _____ me."

(a) help
(b) to help
(c) helping

🧠 Grammar you know

5. "Do you need a hand?" means...

(a) Do you need some help?
(b) Is your hand hurt?
(c) Do you want to hold hands?

🧠 Everyday English

🎉 **How many did you know?**
Now press play and test your ears!

🎧 LISTEN AND FIND OUT

6. What did the man behind Lucy want to buy?

(a) one loaf of bread
(b) two croissants
(c) a birthday cake

🎧 ⏱️ 0:05

7. How many of the 84 people gave their hot chocolate away?

(a) fifteen
(b) seventy-five
(c) all eighty-four

🎧 ⏱️ 1:48

8. In the money experiment, what was in the envelope?

(a) five or twenty dollars
(b) fifty dollars
(c) a gift card

🎧 ⏱️ 5:38

9. What does Jack's grandmother say is the best present?

(a) flowers
(b) a visit
(c) chocolate

🎧 ⏱️ 8:54

10. What did the man from the bakery leave for Lucy?

(a) a loaf of bread
(b) the money back
(c) two croissants and a note

🎧 ⏱️ 20:57

🧤 **Fun fact:** When Lucy dropped her glove, a little girl ran about fifty metres to give it back – her mum was behind her, out of breath!

4 True or false? listening 6 points

Listen and circle **T** (true) or **F** (false). The ⏱️ times help you find the answer.

1	The man in the bakery was happy to let Lucy pay for his bread.	T	F	⏱️ 0:05
2	The givers thought their hot chocolate was "nothing special".	T	F	⏱️ 1:48
3	People who received a kind act were less generous with the next person.	T	F	⏱️ 4:37
4	In the money experiment, twenty dollars made people much happier than five.	T	F	⏱️ 5:38
5	The Oxford review found that kindness makes people a bit happier.	T	F	⏱️ 7:09
6	Kindness to others can replace proper help if you feel low for a long time.	T	F	⏱️ 7:09

5 Two studies and a review 🔍 listening 6 points



Which one is each sentence about? Write **A**, **B** or **C**. ⏱️ 1:48 · 5:38 · 7:09

A · Hot chocolate ☕
2022 · Amit Kumar & Nicholas Epley · a park in Chicago

B · Spending on others 💵
2008 · Elizabeth Dunn, Lara Aknin & Michael Norton

C · The big review 📚
2018 · a team at the University of Oxford

1	People got an envelope with five or twenty dollars inside.	☐
2	People could keep a warm drink or give it to a stranger.	☐
3	It looked at 27 studies with more than 4,000 people.	☐
4	The receivers felt better than the givers expected.	☐
5	The effect on happiness was "small to medium".	☐
6	More than 600 Americans answered questions about how they spend their money.	☐

6 Guess vs reality new! under or over? 6 points



A. Listen at ⏱️ 1:48 and write the two numbers (1 point each). **B.** Underestimated or overestimated? Tick one (1 point each).

😞 much worse — much better 😄

-5 -4 -3 -2 -1 0 +1 +2 +3 +4 +5

🤔 The givers guessed: +_____ 😊 The receivers felt: +_____

Bonus: draw 🤔 and 😊 arrows on the scale!

1. ☕ The givers thought: "It's only a drink." But the strangers felt even better.	☐ ⬇️ underestimated	☐ ⬆️ overestimated
2. 📝 "I thought the test would be really hard, but it was easy."	☐ ⬇️ underestimated	☐ ⬆️ overestimated
3. 🚆 "I thought the journey would take one hour. It took three!"	☐ ⬇️ underestimated	☐ ⬆️ overestimated
4. 🍝 "I bought food for ten people, but only four came."	☐ ⬇️ underestimated	☐ ⬆️ overestimated

7 "Here, I'll walk you there" listening 10 points



It's Jack's first day at a new job, and he's a bit lost. Listen at ⏱ 11:21 and write **one word** in each gap (1–8). Then answer A and B. The breakdown at ⏱ 12:46 can help.

JACK
Excuse me, sorry to 1 _____ you. Do you know where the meeting room is? I think I'm on the wrong floor.





LUCY
Oh, you must be new. You're actually on the right floor, it's just hidden at the end of that corridor. Here, I'll 2 _____ you there.

JACK
Are you sure? I don't want to 3 _____ up your time.





LUCY
It's no 4 _____ at all. I was going that way anyway. Is it your first day?

JACK
It is. And I've already got lost twice.





LUCY
Don't worry, everyone does in this building. If you need a 5 _____ with anything this week, just ask. I'm at the desk by the window.

JACK
That's really kind of you. Thank you so much.





LUCY
Don't 6 _____ it. And if you want, a few of us have lunch together at one. You're 7 _____ to join us.

JACK
I'd love to. I 8 _____ you one.





LUCY
Not at all. Someone did the same for me when I started. Here's the meeting room. Have a great first day.

A. They have lunch together at _____.

B. Lucy's last line is paying it _____.

8 Phrases to steal expressions 4 points

Match each phrase from the chat (1–4) to its meaning (a–d). ⏱ 12:46

- ☐ **1.** "I'll walk you there."
- ☐ **2.** "If you need a hand…"
- ☐ **3.** "You're welcome to join us."
- ☐ **4.** "I owe you one."

a) We'd be happy if you came.
b) You helped me – I'll help you one day.
c) I'll go with you to show you the way.
d) If you need some help…

9 Make or do?

new! collocations · 6 points

Write the right form of **make** or **do**. ⏱️ 16:00 · 16:43



1. 🙏 Could you _____ me a favour?
2. 💌 Your message really _____ my day!
3. 🌱 Small kind acts can _____ a big difference.
4. 🌷 I want to _____ something nice for people.
5. 🌧️ He _____ a real effort to help me.
6. 🚶 A short walk will _____ you good.



Jack's tip: Do is for actions and help: *do a favour, do good, do your best.* **Make** is for results – something new happens: *make a difference, make an effort, make someone's day.* Learn them as pairs! 🧩

10 Your kindness phrasebook

new! offers & replies · 6 points

What do you say? Match each situation (1–6) to a phrase (a–f). ⏱️ 18:12



- ☐ **1.** 🧳 A woman is carrying a heavy suitcase up the stairs.
- ☐ **2.** 🤳 Two tourists are trying to take a selfie.
- ☐ **3.** 🛍️ A man with full arms is walking to a door.
- ☐ **4.** 😊 Someone says, "Thanks so much!"
- ☐ **5.** 🙂 Someone offers to help you, but you're fine.
- ☐ **6.** 💺 Someone gives you their seat on the bus.

a) "Let me get the door for you."
b) "No thanks, I can manage – but thank you!"
c) "Do you need a hand with that?"
d) "Thank you, that's really kind of you."
e) "Would you like me to take a photo for you?"
f) "Any time!"



Lucy's tip: If someone says *"No, thanks"*, that's fine! Just smile and say **"No problem."** You haven't done anything wrong. And remember: accepting kindness well is a gift too. 🎁

🔁 Paid it back or paid it forward?

think · no points



Back = you're kind to the same person who helped you. **Forward** = you're kind to someone new. ⏱️ 4:37 · 20:57

1. 🎂 A neighbour helped you move house, so you bake them a cake. ☐ ⏪ back ☐ ⏩ forward
2. ☕ A stranger paid for your coffee, so you pay for the next person's. ☐ ⏪ back ☐ ⏩ forward
3. 🧭 An old man helped Jack, so now Jack helps people who look lost. ☐ ⏪ back ☐ ⏩ forward
4. 🥐 The man from the bakery left Lucy two croissants. ☐ ⏪ back ☐ ⏩ forward
5. 💼 Someone helped Lucy on her first day, so she helps new colleagues. ☐ ⏪ back ☐ ⏩ forward
6. 🍽️ A friend lent you money, so you take them out for dinner. ☐ ⏪ back ☐ ⏩ forward

11 Say it better

common mistakes · 10 points

These sentences sound unnatural. Write a more natural version (2 points each). ⏱️ 16:43

😐 1. "Thank you!" – "Nothing." 😊 _____

😐 2. "She is very kind with me." 😊 _____

😐 3. "Can I help to you?" 😊 _____

😐 4. "Thank you for your help me." 😊 _____

😐 5. "You are very kind person." 😊 _____



Lucy's tip: Polite is about good manners. **Kind** is about a good heart – so it's usually warmer! And after **for**, use a noun or **-ing**: *"Thank you for your help." / "Thank you for helping me."*

💛 Kind sayings

match · no points

Match each saying (1–4) to its meaning (a–d). ⏱️ 7:09 · 16:00



- ☐ **1.** "She's got a heart of gold."
- ☐ **2.** "A little goes a long way."
- ☐ **3.** "You can't pour from an empty cup."
- ☐ **4.** "He paid it back twice over."

a) Look after yourself too – then you can help others.
b) He gave back more than he got.
c) She's a very kind and good person.
d) A small amount can have a big effect.

💌 Make someone's day – right now! (no points)

Jack's idea: send a short message to a friend you haven't spoken to for a while. Write it here in English first – then send it!

To: _____

Message: _____

_____

💡 Ideas: *"I was thinking about you today. How are you?"* · *"Your photos always make my day!"* · *"Thanks for helping me last week – I owe you one!"*

🌷 Say the nice thing!

write · no points



Jack's tip: don't just *think* the nice thing – say it! Write a compliment for each person. ⏱️ 8:54

🍝 Your friend cooked dinner for you. 💬 *"This is delicious – you're a great cook!"*

🎤 A colleague gave a great presentation. 💬 _____

🌻 Your neighbour's garden looks beautiful. 💬 _____

✂️ Your friend has a new haircut. 💬 _____

12 Clue word search + secret message

puzzle · 10 points



Step 1: Complete each clue – the first letter and the number of letters are given (1 point each). **Step 2:** Find the 10 words in the grid. They go → ↓ ↘ or ↗ and never cross each other.

1. "Your garden looks lovely!" is a **c**_____.
2. A French pastry – Lucy got two: a **c**_____.
3. Happy to give money, time or help: **g**_____.
4. The old man walked Jack to his **h**_____.
5. "Could you do me a **f**_____?"
6. Lucy paid for a stranger's **b**_____.
7. A little girl ran to give Lucy her **g**_____.
8. Jack's grandma: the best present is a **v**_____.
9. Hot chocolate study: an ice-skating **r**_____.
10. Easy kindness: hold the **d**_____ for someone.

C	R	O	I	S	S	A	N	T	K	T
I	G	E	N	E	R	O	U	S	N	N
D	D	N	E	D	S	S	I	E	S	V
O	N	O	A	E	O	F	M	E	T	I
H	E	E	O	F	E	I	V	W	T	S
H	R	I	N	R	L	O	G	S	I	I
B	N	L	I	P	L	F	E	T	H	T
A	T	G	M	G	F	A	V	O	U	R
R	O	O	W	S	W	H	E	N	Y	O
U	C	G	R	I	N	K	I	V	E	I
H	O	S	T	E	L	T	A	W	A	Y

🤫 **Step 3 – the secret message** (no points) Cross out the 10 words. Then write the letters that are left, row by row, from left to right. It's Lucy's last piece of advice in the episode!

_____ _____ _____ _____ _____ _____ _____ _____

_____ _____ _____ _____ _____ _____ _____

_____.

13 The old man in the rain ☔

listening · 6 points



Listen at ⏱️ 19:05. Put the events in the right order. Write 1–6 in the boxes.

- ☐ 🕰️ Jack remembered a clock tower with a green roof.
- ☐ 👴 An old man asked, "Are you lost, son?"
- ☐ 🎒 At nineteen, Jack travelled alone to a city in the north.
- ☐ 💬 "One day, you'll do the same for somebody."
- ☐ 📄 His phone was dead – and he lost the paper with the address.
- ☐ ☔ They walked together in the rain for about 25 minutes.

Think about it 💭 (no points) How does Jack pay it forward today? Write two examples.

14 Your turn

writing · 8 points

2 points for each good sentence.



A. A stranger was kind to me 💛

What happened? Use **go out of their way** or **make my day**. *e.g. "A man went out of his way to help me find the station."*

B. My kindness plan 🌱

What small kind things will you do this week? *e.g. "On Friday, I'm going to call my grandmother."*



⏱️ My kindness week

your 7-day mission

One small act of kindness every day – and use one English phrase if you can!

Day	Small act	What happened? How did it feel?	Done?
1	🚪 **hold a door: "After you."**		☐
2	💬 **message an old friend**		☐
3	🌷 **say a nice thing out loud**		☐
4	🛍️ **"Do you need a hand?"**		☐
5	📞 **call an older relative**		☐
6	⭐ **leave a kind comment**		☐
7	🎁 **accept help: "That's kind!"**		☐

✂️ Cut out and keep in your pocket

🤝 OFFER HELP
Do you need a hand?
Can I help you with that?
Would you like me to...?

🙏 SAY THANKS
Thank you so much!
That's really kind of you.
I owe you one.

😊 REPLY
You're welcome.
No problem. / Any time!
Don't mention it.

💛 KIND WORDS
You made my day!
You've got a heart of gold.
A little goes a long way.

Can you do it now?

I can...	Not yet	Almost	Yes!
explain why we underestimate our own kindness.	😟	🙂	😄
offer help in English: "Do you need a hand?"	😟	🙂	😄
reply to "thank you" in four different ways.	😟	🙂	😄
use do a favour, make a difference and make someone's day.	😟	🙂	😄



Share it with us! Tell us in the comments about a stranger who was kind to you – or something kind you did this week. Did someone **go out of their way** for you? Did someone **make your day**? Your comment might make someone else's day too! 💛

Answer key

Count your points and write your score on page 1!

0 · Warm-up & predict

Guess: c – 75 out of 84 people gave it away. · Predict: **taxi** 🚕 isn't in the episode.

1 · Key words · 2 · The big idea

1 c · 2 g · 3 e · 4 i · 5 j · 6 a · 7 b · 8 d · 9 h · 10 f
Big idea: b (2 points)

3 · Know it or hear it?

1 b · 2 c · 3 b · 4 c · 5 a · 6 a · 7 b · 8 a · 9 b · 10 c

4 · True or false?

1 F (he said "I can pay!" and left quickly) · 2 T · 3 F (they were more generous) · 4 F (the amount wasn't important) · 5 T · 6 F (talk to a doctor)

5 · Two studies and a review · 6 · Guess vs reality

5: 1 B · 2 A · 3 C · 4 A · 5 C · 6 B
6A: givers guessed +2.7 · receivers felt +3.5
6B: 1 underestimated · 2 overestimated · 3 underestimated · 4 overestimated

7 · "Here, I'll walk you there"

1 bother · 2 walk · 3 take · 4 trouble · 5 hand · 6 mention · 7 welcome · 8 owe · A one (o'clock) · B forward

8 · Phrases to steal · Back or forward?

8: 1 c · 2 d · 3 a · 4 b
Back or forward? 1 back · 2 forward · 3 forward · 4 back · 5 forward · 6 back

9 · Make or do? · 10 · Phrasebook

9: 1 do · 2 made · 3 make · 4 do · 5 made · 6 do
10: 1 c · 2 e · 3 a · 4 f · 5 b · 6 d

11 · Say it better (2 points each)

1 You're welcome. / No problem. / Don't mention it. · 2 She's very kind to me. · 3 Can I help you? / Do you need a hand with that? · 4 Thank you for your help. / Thank you for helping me. · 5 You're a very kind person.
Kind sayings: 1 c · 2 d · 3 a · 4 b

12 · Word search (1 point per word)

1 compliment · 2 croissant · 3 generous · 4 hostel · 5 favour · 6 bread · 7 glove · 8 visit · 9 rink · 10 door
Secret: Kindness is one of the few things in life that grows when you give it away.



13 · The old man · 14 · Your turn

1 🎒 travelled alone · 2 📄 lost the paper · 3 👴 "Are you lost, son?" · 4 🕰️ clock tower · 5 ☔ walked in the rain · 6 💬 "One day, you'll do the same"
Think about it: he always stops to help people who look lost – to find train stations, hospitals, even a little dog's owner.
14: your own answers – 2 points per good sentence.

Your score

90–100 🏆 **A heart of gold!** · 70–89 ✨ **You made my day** · 50–69 🥐 **Paying it forward** · 0–49 🥖 **Bread traffic jam – listen again!**

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